Logo

68 days to Gateway cutover · US-only from Jan 1, 2027

ER OUT-OF-NETWORK REVENUE CYCLE

2027 Operating Model

Ten full-cycle teams that own every account from coding to final payment, a five-person US desk that enters our prepared IDR disputes in the Gateway, and a career path built on skill. Designed to take us from 12 to 31 facilities.

94
Lebanon team. No one loses their job or pay because of the restructure

10
Full-cycle teams, one per manager

5
US desk (Model C): 1 working lead and 4 associates

2,500
Batched IDR disputes a month, about 20,800 codes

12 → 31
Facilities over the next two years

WHY CHANGE

Three pressures arriving at the same time

Jan 1

The IDR Gateway goes US-only

Only US-based staff can work in the Gateway. Our negotiators spend 50–70% of their time there today.

5×

Workload depends on the facility

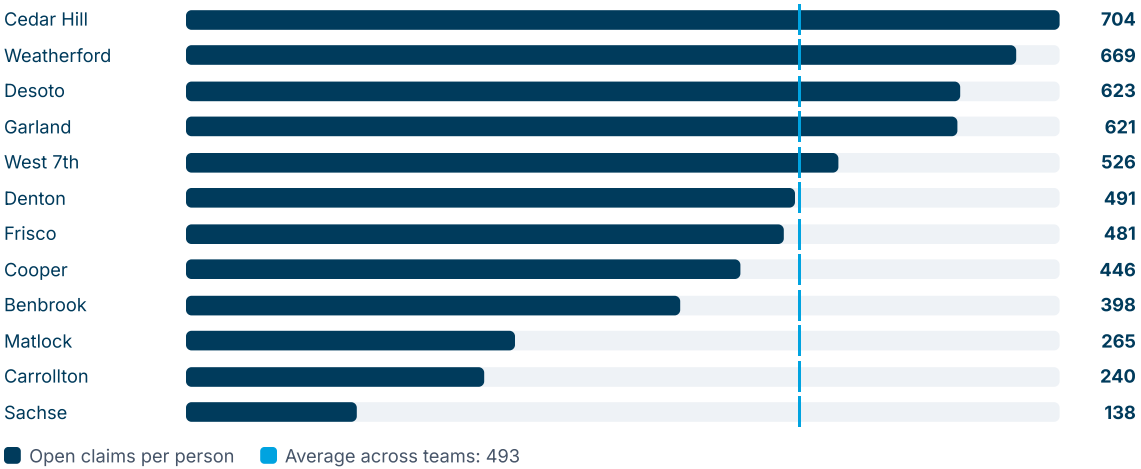
One team carries 704 open claims per person, another 138. People are tied to one site, so work can't move.

+19

Facilities opening in two years

9 next year and 10 the year after. Under facility teams, each opening needs a new team.

Open claims per team member, by facility team today



What the current setup costs us

Handoffs on the riskiest step
Billers send the Open Negotiation notice, negotiators take over after.

Idle coding capacity
10 coders, about 12 charts each per day.

Appeals that don't pay
NNSA claims appealed 4–5 years; no recoveries after year one.

Titles that don't matter
Strong coders and billers have no path past negotiators.

ORGANIZATION CHART

Ten managers, ten identical teams, one small US desk

Each team does the work end to end. An opt-in night rota of specialists keeps disputes clean for the US desk. Three team managers also run a shared program, and QA stays the separate department it is today.

Head of ER OON Revenue Cycle
Owns results, structure and the US desk

LEBANON — Full-Cycle Teams

10 managers · 12 team leads · 72 RCM specialists

Team 1 7–8 specialists	**Team 2** 7–8 specialists	**Team 3** 7–8 specialists	**Team 4** 7–8 specialists	**Team 5** 7–8 specialists
Team 6 7–8 specialists	**Team 7** 7–8 specialists	**Team 8** 7–8 specialists	**Team 9** 7–8 specialists	**Team 10** 7–8 specialists

Inside every team

Manager (L5)	Team results, payer strategy, 1:1s, named contact for one facility
Team Lead (L5)	Daily work, deadline board, first-line QA, rebalancing
7–8 Specialists	L0 Junior RCM Specialist · L1 RCM Specialist I · L2 RCM Specialist II · L3 Senior Specialist I · L4 Senior Specialist II ★

LEBANON — Bridge Night Rota

Opt-in L2–L4 with B2 · A2 night lead · 2 a night · 16:00–24:00 Beirut, Mon–Fri

Duties
Check tickets due that day; answer the US desk within 15 minutes; fix rejects the same US day; nightly handover log

Targets
98% first-pass tickets, answers within 15 minutes, no deadline missed because of a ticket

Quarterly bonus
$30,000 pool shared equally: $300–3,000 per member. Transport home after the shift

Shared programs, each run by one team manager: Academy and badges · Pricing guide · Onshore–Offshore Liaison (US desk; night rota reports here)

QA department (separate): checklists, audit sample, seat on the Badge Panel

UNITED STATES — IDR Gateway Desk · Model C

1 working lead · 4 associates · two shifts, 07:00–19:00 Central

Working lead
Credentials, coverage, same-day completion; also enters disputes

4 Gateway associates
Copy each field from the IDR Prep Studio into the Gateway and submit personally; download determinations

Lebanon prepares, US enters
No pricing decisions on the US desk. Only US staff work in the Gateway; no tool touches it

Kept minimal
About 15 minutes per dispute. $252,000–307,000 a year today; grows only on the backlog trigger

10
Managers, one per team

12
Team leads (10 teams + 2 floating, covering absences and the Academy)

72
RCM specialists in Lebanon (L0–L4)

5
US Gateway Desk (Model C)

HOW WORK FLOWS

One owner per account, from chart to closure

If the owner doesn't hold the skill badge for a step, a badge-holder in the same team does it while the owner learns. Work never leaves the team.

1. **Code the chart**
   Plus the medical-necessity report, written once
2. **Confirm receipt**
   Log the mail date; confirm the payer has the claim
3. **Open negotiation**
   OMB notice, then 30 business days to settle
4. **IDR or appeal**
   Dispute prepared in the IDR Prep Studio, entered by the US desk; NNSA claims go to appeal
5. **Post and match**
   Payments posted; awards matched to determinations
6. **Close**
   Unpaid awards chased after 30 days

Account owner: one RCM Specialist in one team, steps 1 to 6

Team in Lebanon
Builds the dispute, picks the offer, prepares final documents in the IDR Prep Studio

IDR Prep Studio
Mirrors the Gateway page by page and checks every field. Ready by 3:30 pm Beirut (7:30 am Dallas).

US Gateway Desk
Copies each field into the Gateway with one-click copy buttons and submits personally, the same day

Work going to the US desk · Status and determinations coming back

8-hour time gap
Lebanon prepares during its day, the US files during its day. The night rota covers the overlap.

Rework costs a day
First-pass ticket accuracy is tracked from day one.

US desk: 5 people
About 15 minutes per dispute with the guided copy desk. Absorbs one absence without falling behind.

Balanced by effort
Work units: OMB notice 1 · negotiation 2 · NNSA appeal 2 · IDR initiation 3 · offer and packet 4 · MVA 5.

Gateway filing: three models considered. We propose Model C.

	Model A · People-first	Model B · Automation-first	Model C · Guided copy desk
How filing works	US desk types from ClickUp tickets	A form filler fills the Gateway; operator checks and submits	US desk copies each field from the IDR Prep Studio and submits. No tool touches the Gateway
Time per dispute	About 47 min	Target 10 min	Target 15 min
US desk today / Y1 / Y2	7 / 12 / 18	3 / 5 / 7	5 / 8 / 11
Cost a year today	$346,000–421,000	$192,000–244,000	$252,000–307,000
Cost in year 2	$861,000–1,050,000	$412,000–504,000	$533,000–650,000
Outside approvals	Legal sign-off on the onshore rule	Also written Gateway confirmation	Legal sign-off on the onshore rule only
Ready for Jan 1	Yes	No; runs on A's desk until Apr 30	Yes; Studio built and tested

Model C saves $94–114K a year today and $328–400K by year two against Model A, about 60–75% of Model B's saving with far less risk. Lebanon prepares, US enters; no pricing decisions on the US desk. Gate C1 on March 15, 2027: 15 minutes or less per dispute, errors under 0.5%, no missed deadlines for 4 weeks. US desk costs use approximate Texas market rates for direct hires, plus about 25% benefits and payroll taxes.

Bridge night rota: opt-in, 2 members a night

- **Who:** any L2, L3 or L4 holding B2 (IDR Process Workflow). Each night has at least one A2 holder as night lead. Team leads no longer staff it.
- **Hours:** 16:00–24:00 Beirut, Monday to Friday (08:00–16:00 US Central). 10 member-nights a week, 130 a quarter.
- **Option 1:** 10 members, each 1 night a week (13 nights a quarter).
- **Option 2:** 20 members, each 1 night every other week (6–7 nights a quarter).
- **Full share** when the rota meets its targets and the member works all assigned nights. Swaps allowed; missed nights reduce the share pro rata.

Quarterly bonus: $30,000 pool, shared equally

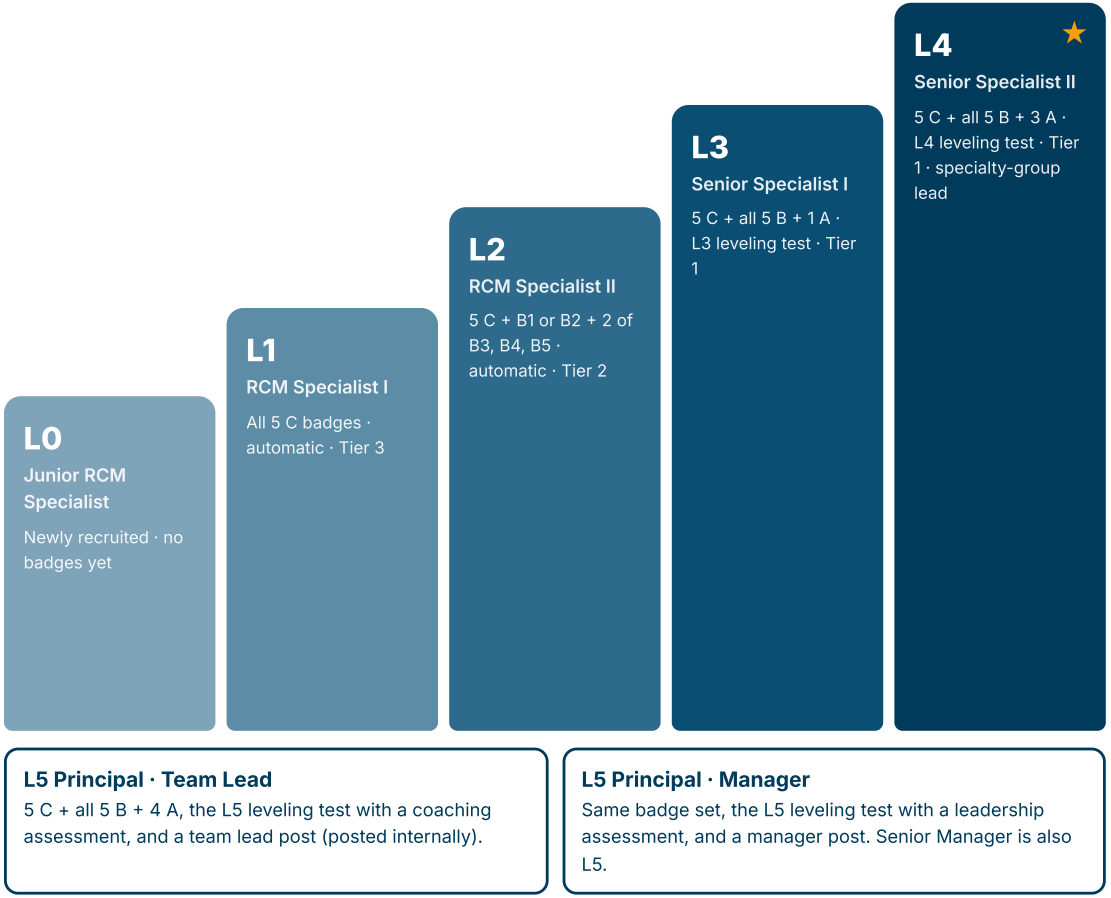
Rota size	Per member a quarter
10 members	$3,000
15 members	$2,000
20 members	$1,500
30 members	$1,000
50 members	$600
100 members (cap)	$300

About $230 per night worked at any size. Up to $120,000 a year.

CAREERS

One role, six levels, 15 skill badges

Level comes from the badges you hold and your results. Your old title as coder, biller or negotiator plays no part. L1 and L2 follow automatically from badges; L3, L4 and L5 need a leveling test. L5 Principal is the leadership level, held only by Team Leads, Managers and the Senior Manager.



L5 Principal · Team Lead
5 C + all 5 B + 4 A, the L5 leveling test with a coaching assessment, and a team lead post (posted internally).

L5 Principal · Manager
Same badge set, the L5 leveling test with a leadership assessment, and a manager post. Senior Manager is also L5.

Badge codes: **C** = Core, **B** = Specialist, **A** = Advanced.

Core badges · all five for L1

- C1 Attaching Docs
- C2 Claim Follow-up
- C3 Appeal
- C4 Payment Posting
- C5 Medical-Necessity Report

Specialist badges · three for L2, all five for L3

- B1 Coding
- B2 IDR Process Workflow
- B3 MVA and WComp Negotiation & Process
- B4 Payer Strategy
- B5 Payer Outreach

Advanced badges · the team's experts ★

- A1 Reporting and Analysis
- A2 IDR Strategy
- A3 Medical Terminology
- A4 Billing Strategy
- A5 Innovation

A raise on every move up
Every move up a level comes with a pay raise, including the move to Team Lead or Manager. No minimum time in level.

No one's pay goes down
Pay is protected for everyone, including anyone whose level is reset. Annual reviews follow the company's existing policy.

Rewarding tenure
Extra leave days at 2, 3, 5 and 10 years, one external course a year, first pick of shifts and a service award.

How you move up

- **L1 and L2 are automatic.** The move happens at the next quarterly window after the badges are held.
- **Leveling tests for L3, L4 and L5** in the quarterly windows: a case-based exam across the level's badges, plus a review of the last 6 months (QA 95%+ for L3, 97%+ for L4 and L5; zero missed deadlines). L5 adds a coaching or leadership assessment.
- **Annual top 10%:** every December, members are ranked within their level. The top 10% automatically earn any badges of their level they don't yet hold. An L2 in the top 10% moves up to L3 without the test and earns any missing L3 badges within 12 months.
- **New hires:** L0 two-week onboarding, then C1 and C4 (months 1–2), C2 and C5 (months 3–4), C3 (months 5–6) and L1. B1 or B2 plus 2 of B3, B4, B5 brings L2, typically 6–12 months later.
- **Who teaches and assesses:** L4 Senior Specialists II and Team Leads train. Each Badge Panel is a QA reviewer plus 2 assessors (L4s or Team Leads) from other teams.

Tests, reviews and badge loss

- **Quarterly test windows:** last two weeks of March, June, September and December. Every badge test and the leveling tests. Enrol up to 4 weeks before. People who already do the work can test out, then do 10 supervised cases.
- **Semiannual KPI review** on June 30 and December 31. A badge is lost below its QA keep threshold, with 2+ critical errors, or if suspended and not re-earned.
- **Losing 25% or more** of badges held (rounded up): 90 days of probation and coaching. **Losing 50% or more:** termination through the HR process, with one appeal. Subject to HR and legal review under Lebanese labor law.
- **The level follows the badges** and is reset at the next window; pay protection applies. June 2027 is coaching-only. Consequences start with the December 2027 review.

Level	Badges held	Probation at	Termination at
L1	5	2 lost	3 lost
L2	8	2 lost	4 lost
L3	11	3 lost	6 lost
L4	13	4 lost	7 lost
L5	14	4 lost	7 lost

The 15 badges: Academy module, supervised production, assessment in a test window

Badge	Covers	Prerequisite	Classroom	QA to earn / keep
C1 Attaching Docs	Attaching and indexing EOBs, remits, records and payer letters to the right account; requesting missing documents	None	4 h	98% / 97%
C2 Claim Follow-up	Confirming payer receipt, status follow-up, next-action dates, resubmission requests	C1	8 h	95% / 93%
C3 Appeal	Code and money appeals (NNSA), non-NSA denials, appeal letter library, payer limits, 12-month closing rule	C2	10 h	95% / 93%
C4 Payment Posting	ERA exceptions, manual posting, IDR award payments, adjustments, refunds, claim closure	None	8 h	99% / 98%
C5 Medical-Necessity Report	Report from the approved LLM prompt library, checked against the chart, filed within 1 business day	C1	8 h	97% / 96%
B1 Coding	ER professional and facility coding: E/M levels, procedures, ICD-10, modifiers, scrubbing, claim-form prep	C5	20 h	95% / 95%
B2 IDR Process Workflow	NSA eligibility, Open Negotiation notice and period, IDR initiation, batching, Studio entry, deadlines, determinations	C2	14 h	98% / 97%
B3 MVA and WComp Negotiation & Process	Order of coverage, workers' comp process and fee schedules, liens, attorney correspondence, adjuster negotiation	C2 and C3	12 h	95% / 93%
B4 Payer Strategy	Owning the playbook for 1–2 payers: QPA patterns, outcome trends, offer ranges; feeds the pricing guide	B2	10 h	90% scorecard
B5 Payer Outreach	Payer calls, portals, provider-relations contacts, call scripts, escalation paths	C2	8 h	95% / 93%
A1 Reporting and Analysis	Reports and dashboards from ClickUp and eCW exports, KPI definitions, monthly trend analysis	L2	12 h	90% scorecard
A2 IDR Strategy	Offer setting, IDR entity selection and objections, packet writing, batching strategy, outcome review	B2	16 h	97% + 98% first-pass / 96% + 97%
A3 Medical Terminology	Anatomy, ER clinical terms and abbreviations, reading complex charts for coding, appeals and reports	C5	12 h	95% / 93%
A4 Billing Strategy	Payer billing rules, timely-filing strategy, denial prevention, the billing rule library, upstream fixes	C2 and C3	12 h	90% scorecard
A5 Innovation	Improvement projects (ClickUp automations, AI prompts, Studio improvements) with measured results	L2	10 h	90% scorecard

Classroom: C family 38 h, B family 64 h, A family 62 h. Critical errors fail a case regardless of score: document on the wrong account, missed deadline, PHI to the wrong party or an unapproved tool, unsupported code or level, appeal after the payer's limit, settlement or offer outside decision rights, unbalanced posting batch.

Transition: January to March 2027

- **December 2026:** everyone ranked within their current role on 2026 KPIs. Default level: Seniors L3; Negotiators, Coders and Billers L2; Team Leads and Managers keep their posts at L5.
- **Role badges:** Negotiator C2, C5, B2, B5, A2. Coder C1, C5, B1, A3. Biller C1, C2, C3, C4, B5, plus B3 for those doing MVA or workers' comp. Senior: the role badges of their specialty.
- **Top 10% of each role:** earn their role badges automatically, no tests, and are confirmed at their default level.
- **Bottom 10%:** placed at L1 and enrolled in the Academy. They return to L2 automatically once they hold the L2 badges.
- **Everyone else:** optional skill assessment in January, then 3 months (January 4 to March 31) to pass their role badges in the February or March windows. Pass: confirmed. Fail: down one level. Pass the next level's tests: up one level.
- **April 1, 2027:** levels take effect. Missing badges for the confirmed level are earned through cross-training by December 31, 2027; the level is held provisionally until then.
- **Team Leads and Managers** keep their posts and have until December 31, 2027 to complete the L5 badge set, with Academy support. New L5 appointments need the full set and the leveling test.
- **Pay:** no one's pay goes down, including anyone moved down. Every move up comes with a pay raise from April 1, 2027.

Our commitment: No one loses their job or pay because of the restructure. From December 2027 everyone is held to the same badge and performance standards.

GROWTH

What it takes to go from 12 to 31 facilities

Assumes new sites average 10 visits a day, like today. Today's spare capacity covers about three new facilities; after that we hire on workload triggers.



★ **7** new manager seats

★ **14** new team lead seats

About 21 leadership seats in two years, posted inside first. Today's team leads are the natural managers, and our L3 and L4 Senior Specialists become the next team leads.

Open a new team
When teams run above 110% of target workload for 4 weeks.

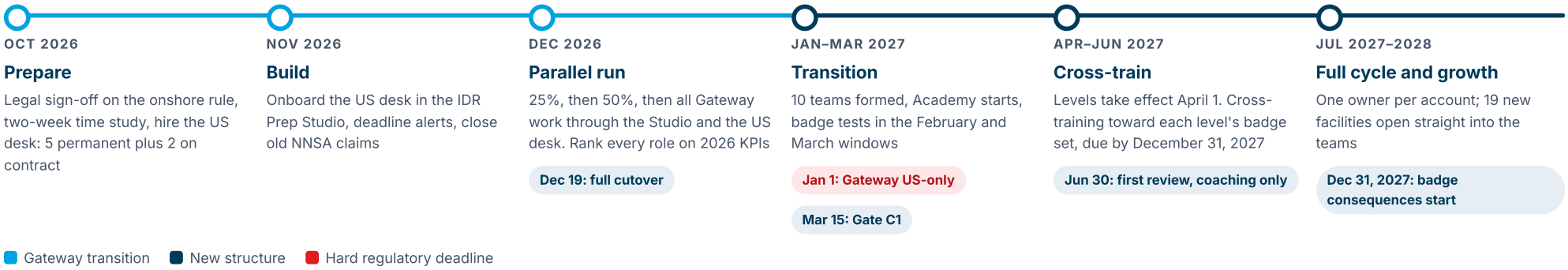
Add US desk staff
When the ticket backlog stays above 1 business day for 2 weeks.

Hire ahead
About 3 months early, in monthly Academy groups of 4–6.

ROADMAP

Gateway first, then the new structure

We stabilize the Gateway change before we touch team structure, so any problem in December has one clear cause.



SCORECARD

How we'll know it's working

Each specialist

- Net Recovery on their portfolio
- Zero missed deadlines
- Quality score
- Work units against target
- Ticket accuracy

Each team

- Team Net Recovery
- Days from service to final payment
- Claims over 90 and 180 days
- Awards paid within 30 days
- Attrition

US Gateway Desk

- Disputes entered the same day
- Minutes per dispute (target 15)
- Copy errors under 0.5%
- Backlog at end of day

Coding

- Coding accuracy
- Days from service to submission
- NSA vs non-NSA classification errors

Net Recovery = (collected − initial payment − IDR fees not refunded) ÷ (billed − initial payment). Compared within the same portfolio tier.

Zero tolerance on deadlines. ClickUp counts every NSA deadline in business days and alerts the team lead, then the manager, three days before it's due.

GLOSSARY

What the codes stand for

C1–C5	Core badges: Attaching Docs, Claim Follow-up, Appeal, Payment Posting, Medical-Necessity Report. All five for L1
A1–A5	Advanced badges: Reporting and Analysis, IDR Strategy, Medical Terminology, Billing Strategy, Innovation. 1 for L3, 3 for L4, 4 for L5
L5	Principal (Leadership): Team Leads, Managers and the Senior Manager only
IDR Prep Studio	Internal portal that mirrors the Gateway page by page and checks every field before the US desk copies it in
OON	Out of network
NNSA	Non-NSA claims, handled through appeals
IDRE	The independent arbitrator that decides an IDR dispute
QPA	Qualifying payment amount: the payer's median in-network rate
DOS	Date of service
Badge Panel	A QA reviewer plus 2 assessors (L4s or Team Leads) from other teams who assess badges
Test window	Last two weeks of each quarter, when every badge test and leveling test can be taken
B1–B5	Specialist badges: Coding, IDR Process Workflow, MVA and WComp, Payer Strategy, Payer Outreach. B1 or B2 plus 2 of B3–B5 for L2; all five for L3
L0–L4	Specialist levels: Junior RCM Specialist, RCM Specialist I, RCM Specialist II, Senior Specialist I, Senior Specialist II
Leveling test	Case-based exam plus a 6-month results review, required for L3, L4 and L5
TL	Team Lead
NSA	No Surprises Act: federal law covering out-of-network emergency claims
IDR	Independent Dispute Resolution, the federal process for NSA payment disputes
OMB	The OMB-approved Open Negotiation notice that starts the 30-business-day negotiation
MVA	Motor vehicle accident claims
QA	Quality assurance; the separate QA department
Night rota	Opt-in L2–L4 members holding B2, 2 a night with an A2 holder as night lead, 16:00–24:00 Beirut, overlapping the US desk's day